

Start Here

Mac Setup Companion — a calm, practical first pass for your Mac

Open the app

Open the online companion at **mac-setup-companion.vercel.app**. Sign in to Vercel if it asks. Your progress stays in the browser you use.

To run a local copy instead, open **Terminal** and paste:

```
cd "/Users/zaynab/Documents/github/mac-setup-companion"  
~/ .bun/bin/bun run dev
```

Then open the address Terminal shows you—normally **http://localhost:8080**. Keep Terminal open while you use the local app.

If Terminal says something is missing, run `~/ .bun/bin/bun install` once in the same folder, then try again.

Your five-step first pass

Open **Start Here** in the app. These are deliberately small actions:

1. **Orient** — In Finder Settings, show the Path Bar and filename extensions. Put Downloads and current project folders in the sidebar.
2. **Retrieve** — Find one known file by name, then by a phrase inside it. Fix search before building more around it.
3. **Reduce new clutter** — Choose a real Screenshots folder. Use a clipboard-only capture when you do not need a file.
4. **Make one queue** — Create a **Review** tag and a Finder Smart Folder for files carrying that tag.
5. **Automate one repetition** — Make one Shortcut for selected files. Test it on copies before adding triggers.

The goal is not to do everything today. Make one small system that you can see working.

Use the core manual

- Start with **Begin Core Setup** and move through the chapters in order.
- Each screen gives orientation, a real action, and a way to check the result.
- **Next** only moves you forward; it never marks a task finished.
- Choose **Mark complete** only after you have actually done the action.
- Notes and companion guides are optional; companions never disturb your place in the core manual.

A good first session

Give yourself 20–30 minutes. Complete the five-step first pass, then open Chapter 00. Stop after you have one reliable next action—not when you have tried to perfect the whole computer.

Source code: github.com/xyzaynab/mac-setup-companion. Progress and notes stay in the browser you use; clearing its site data may remove them.